The warming flavors of steak and onions make this soup a rich and satisfying meal. For an authentic touch, use Hungarian paprika—it is fairly readily available these days.

hungarian goulash soup

SERVES 6–8 **PREP** 15 MINS **COOK** 2 HRS **FREEZE** UP TO 3 MONTHS

4 tbsp olive oil
1½lb (675g) onions, thinly sliced
2 garlic cloves, crushed
1½lb (675g) chuck steak, cut into 2in (5cm) cubes
salt and freshly ground black pepper
2 tbsp paprika
1 tsp caraway seeds
1 tsp cayenne pepper, plus extra to garnish
4 tbsp tomato purée
1 quart (1 liter) beef stock
sour cream, to garnish

1 Heat 3 tbsp of the olive oil in a large heavy saucepan over medium heat, add the onions, and cook, stirring occasionally, for 10 minutes or until they are golden brown. Add the garlic for the final 2 minutes, then remove from the heat.

2 Heat the remaining oil in a frying pan, add the steak, and cook, stirring often, for 5 minutes or until brown on all sides. Season with salt and add to the onions, along with the spices and tomato purée. Return the saucepan to the heat and cook for 5 minutes, stirring all the time, then pour in the stock. Cover with a lid and simmer gently for 1¾ hours.

3 Season to taste with salt and freshly ground black pepper, then serve the soup garnished with sour cream, a sprinkling of cayenne, and some more freshly ground black pepper.